Wei Yang Tham

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Academic Appointments

Staff Scientist, University of Toronto	2024 - present
Research Scientist, Harvard Business School	2022 - 2024
Postdoctoral Fellow, Harvard Business School	2019 - 2022
Graduate Research Assistant for Bruce Weinberg and David Blau, The Ohio State University	2015 - 2019

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, The Ohio State University	Aug 2019
M.A. in Economics, The Ohio State University	Jun 2014
B.A. in Economics, Rice University	Jun 2013

Publications

Science, Interrupted: Funding Delays Reduce Research Activity but Having More Grants Helps. (*PLOS ONE*, 2023)

Unequal effects of the COVID-19 pandemic on scientists (with Kyle R. Myers, Yian Yin, Nina Cohodes, Jerry G. Thursby, Marie C. Thursby, Peter Schiffer, Joseph T. Walsh, Karim R. Lakhani, and Dashun Wang). (*Nature Human Behaviour*, 2020)

Money, Time, and Grant Design (*American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, forthcoming)
with Kyle Myers
NBER SI 2023 (Science of Science Funding)
Coverage: *Nature*

New Facts and Data about Professors and their Research (*PLOS ONE*, 2026)
with Kyle Myers, Nina Cohodes, Karim Lakhani, Rachel Mural, Jerry Thursby, Marie Thursby, Yilun Xu
Coverage: *Nature*

Working Papers

Scientific Talent Leaks Out of Funding Gaps (conditionally accepted, *Review of Economics and Statistics*)
with Joseph Staudt, Elisabeth Perlman, Stephanie Cheng
NBER SI 2022 (Innovation), NBER SI 2024 (Science of Science Funding)
Coverage: *Marginal Revolution*; *Good Science Project*; *Nature (Career Feature)*; *Nature (News)*; *STAT News*
Related policy memo: *The Talent Cost of Funding Delays*

Productivity Beliefs and Efficiency in Science (submitted)
with Fabio Bertolotti, Kyle Myers

Database, Methodological Tools, and Research Opportunities: Creative Destruction Lab and Early-Stage Technology Ventures
with Amir Sariri, Evgenia Gatov, Geneva Neal, Kyle Robinson, Sonia Sennik, Michael Vertolli & Avi Goldfarb

Research in Progress

Estimating the Scientific Production Function
with Jeff Qiu and Bruce Weinberg

The Effect of Temporary Colocation on Knowledge Flows: Evidence from NIH Study Sections (slides)

Reproducibility and Automation in Science
with Ilya Yakavets, Yimu Zhao, Mohammad Nazeri, Sheldon Mei, Daniel Lin, Sonia Azimi Dijvejin, Avi Goldfarb

Policy Memos & White Papers

The Talent Cost of Funding Delays

Measuring Innovation in Science (NBER-IFS White Papers on the Value of Medical Research)

Teaching Experience

Department of Economics, The Ohio State University

ECON 2367.02 Economic Issues in the United States — Fall 2017
Independent Instructor

ECON 2002.01 Principles of Macroeconomics — Fall 2016
Teaching Assistant

ECON 2001.01 Principles of Microeconomics — Fall 2014
Teaching Assistant

Grants, Fellowships, & Awards

Fellow, NBER-IFS Value of Health Research Network ($10,000) — 2017
University Fellowship, Graduate School at The Ohio State University — 2013-2014

Presentations

** indicates coauthor presented*

2026
Georgia Tech, Carter School of Public Policy

2025
Accelerate Conference

2023
NBER Innovation Information Initiative (I3) Technical Working Group*
The Ohio State University Applied Micro Seminar
The Growth Lab (Harvard Kennedy School)
Advances with Field Experiments (AFE) 2023 Conference
AIEA-NBER Conference 2023
NBER Summer Institute 2023, Science of Science Funding
International Conference on the Science of Science and Innovation (ICSSI)
UMass Amherst Applied Micro Workshop
DRUID
BSE Summer Forum, Economics of Science and Innovation*

2022
NBER Summer Institute 2022, Innovation
DRUID

Midwest Economics Association Conference
NBER Investments in Early Career Scientists Meeting (April 2022)
Society of Labor Economists, 27th Annual Meeting

2021
Western Economic Association Conference
Evidence for Science Policy – UMETRICS in Action Series

2020
Panel on *Doing science in times of crisis: Science studies perspectives on COVID-19*, 2nd edition
14th Workshop on the Organisation, Economics and Policy of Scientific Research at the Max Planck Institute for Innovation and Competition
Eastern Economic Association Conference

2019
2nd Research on Innovation, Science and Entrepreneurship Workshop at the Max Planck Institute for Innovation and Competition
MTEI Research Seminar, EPFL (École polytechnique fédérale de Lausanne)

2018
Department of Economics, SUNY Albany
Department of Economics, The Ohio State University
Census ARiS Brown Bag
13th Meeting of the Urban Economics Association
Value of Medical Research Network Meeting
Society of Labor Economists (SOLE) Annual Meeting (poster)
Midwest Economics Association Conference

REFEREEING — JPE Micro; Science; Economic Journal; Economic Inquiry; Industrial and Labor Relations Review; Regional Science and Urban Economics; Research Policy; Studies in Higher Education

LEADERSHIP — Founder and President of Economics Graduate Student Society 2016 - 2018

SKILLS — R, Git, Stata, SQL, MATLAB, Unix (basic)
Languages: English (native), Chinese (fluent), French (basic)

CITIZENSHIP — Singapore

REFERENCES

Professor Kyle R. Myers — E-mail: kmyers@hbs.edu
Technology and Operations Management Unit
Harvard Business School

Professor Bruce A. Weinberg — E-mail: weinberg.27@osu.edu
Department of Economics
The Ohio State University

Professor Avi Goldfarb — E-mail: agoldfarb@rotman.utoronto.ca
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